https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/congress-mla-ratan-lal-nath-to-join-bjp-in-tripura/articleshow/62196958.cms; PTI, 'Former Congress MLA Manoj Kanti Deb joins BJP', *The Financial Express,* 7 September 2017, https://www.financialexpress.com/india-news/former-congress-mla-manoj-kanti-deb-joins-bjp/845346/lite/; 'Recognise ex-TMC MLAs as BJP members in Tripura: BJP', *North East Today*, 20 September 2017, https://web.archive.org/web/20170924001722/https://www.northeasttoday.in/recognise-ex-tmc-mlas-as-bjp-members-in-tripura-bjp/.

76. These included a host of leaders from the Trinamool Congress; Congress leaders like Sudip Roy Burman (MLA from Agartala), Ashish Kumar Saha (MLA from Town Borwoali), Diba Chandra Hrangkhwal (Karamchchara), Biswa Bandhu Sen (Dharmanagar), Pranajit Singh Roy (Radhakishorepur) and Dilip Sarkar (Badarghat). Details are from Shubhrajeet Konwer, 'BJP and coalition politics: Strategic alliances in the states of Northeast', *Social Change and Development*, Vol. XVI, No 1, 2019, p. 41.

77. This count is by Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty, 'How Modi government brought the Northeast into its fold', *The Wire*, 18 March 2018, https://thewire.in/politics/how-modi-government-brought-the-northeast-into-its-fold.

78. For more on the mass of defections to BJP that followed its election victories, see, for instance, Bikash Singh, 'It's destination BJP for Assam Congress netas', *The Economic Times*, 13 August 2019, https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/its-destination-bjp-for-assam-congress-netas/articleshow/70649271.cms; HT Correspondent, '15 AGP leaders join BJP in Dima Hasao', *The Hills Times*, 7 March 2019, https://www.thehillstimes.in/regional/15-agp-leaders-join-bjp-in-dima-hasao/; NE Now News, 'Assam: Former senior Congress stalwarts join BJP', *North East Now*, 11 August 2019, https://nenow.in/north-east-news/assam-former-senior-congress-stalwarts-formally-join-bjp.html; Anup Biswas, 'Many AGP leaders join BJP in Dima Hasao', 8 March 2019, https://www.apnnews.com/many-agp-leaders-join-bjp-in-dima-hasao/.